

WHEEL

Urdhva Dhanurasana

Wheel is a full backbend and inversion, bringing your head below the level of your heart. This pose is often done toward the end of a class as it requires warming up to be safe for most people. With practice, Wheel can improve the strength and flexibility of your back.

THE BIG PICTURE

This pose strongly stretches the muscles at the front of your body—including your thighs, hips, abdomen, and chest. It strengthens your shoulders and the back of your body—particularly your back muscles, buttocks, and thighs—as they support you in this deep backbend and elevation.

KEY

•-- Joints

○ Muscles

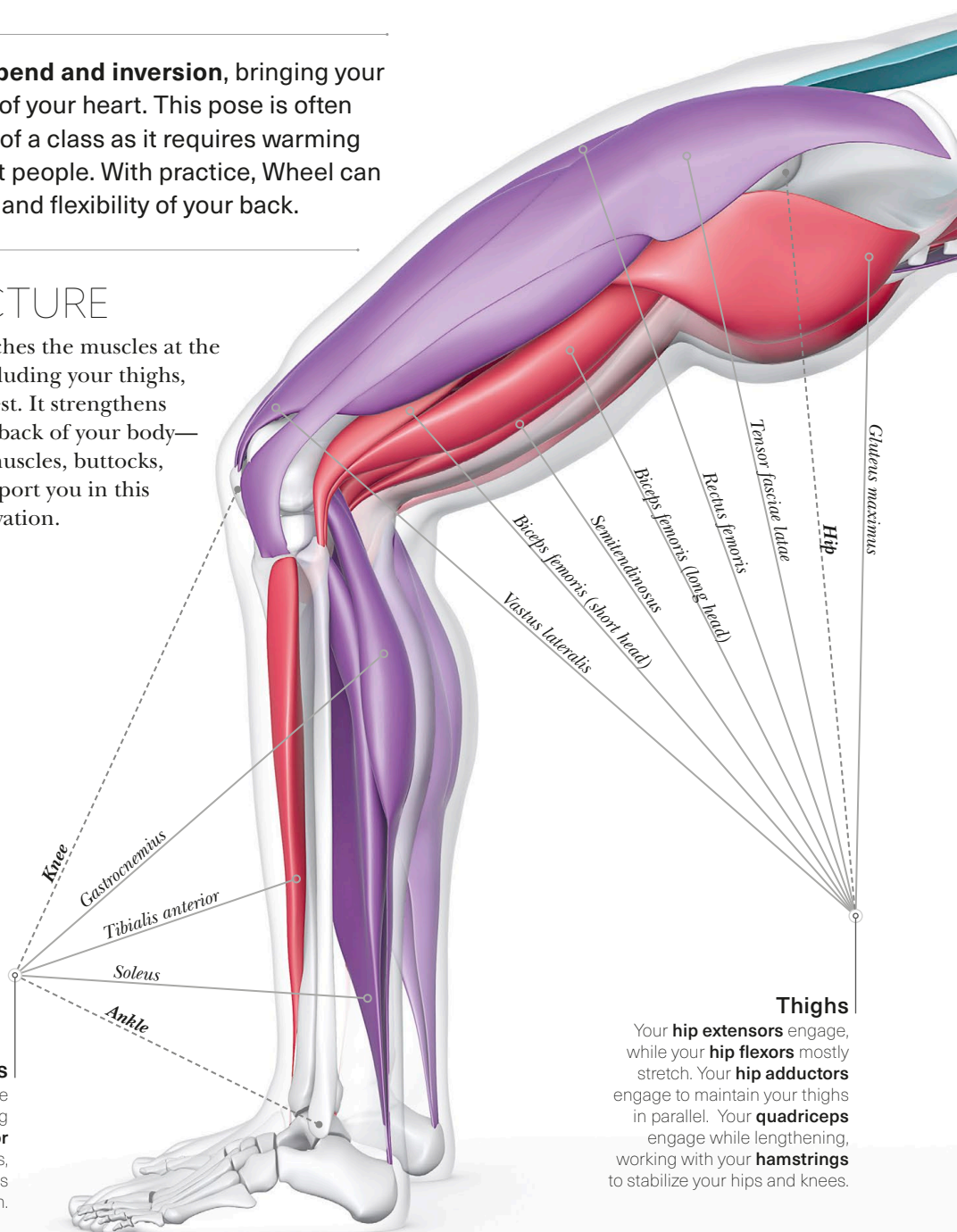
● Engaging

● Engaging while stretching

● Stretching

Lower legs

Your **calf muscles** stabilize while in a neutral or lengthening position. Your **tibialis anterior muscles** dorsiflex your ankles, aligning your shins and knees directly over them.



Thighs

Your **hip extensors** engage, while your **hip flexors** mostly stretch. Your **hip adductors** engage to maintain your thighs in parallel. Your **quadriceps** engage while lengthening, working with your **hamstrings** to stabilize your hips and knees.